

Active Inference ~ Twitter Spaces #002 ~ Web3 survive without cognitive modeling?

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talking i'm ready

okay hope that this is working well and i guess this is where we can begin the conversation this is a twitter spaces on september 14 2022 it is called can web 3 survive without cognitive modeling and i know there's something they say about headlines that end in a question mark something like always there are yes answers or no answers or in this conversation we're going to be talking about web 3 and about cognitive modeling and it will be less than an hour long hopefully will serve as a nice introduction to those who have little or some familiarity with web 3 and cognitive modeling alone or together but it's also meant to be kind of a broad-ranging discussion and hopefully we'll have some other voices come up and add in some thoughts and questions let's start with just a description of web 3. surely elsewhere you'll be able to find audio and other kinds of content describing web 3. so i'll just describe what's relevant about it as we talk about cognitive modeling web 3. web 3 is an ongoing movement that is applying blockchain and other distributed technologies to a wide-ranging areas and we can think of web 3 as creating critical infrastructure of the public goods type or not necessarily public goods in a wide range of areas so in finance there's decentralized finance or defy and defy requires the engineering of token schemes which is sometimes called token engineering or tokenomics such that those token-based systems are able to be designed effectively and operate effectively and there's a lot of other areas outside of the financial that are important for web 3. for example community governance and meta governance like what people may have heard about dows decentralized autonomous organizations as well as all other kinds of organizations and of particular interest for our institute and for many others is decentralized science or design and in many ways dsci will succeed if it can have a balanced and coherent approach to tackle all the challenges that face the research and education stack ranging from the who what why where when etc our question that we'll return to is how can any of these areas finance community research science and education how can any of these areas be successfully navigated or designed for without taking agents into account so this is very related to agent-based modeling and we're going to explore how there are several approaches to modeling these complex systems and we're going to suggest that complementing top-down structural modeling of these systems there's a really important role for agentic or what we can consider cognitive modeling of the actors in these systems themselves and we believe that without this kind of like a bottom-up individual driven account taken conceptually into the design process but also more formally into the specification and evaluation of these critical infrastructure systems that there are going to be a lot of blind spots and a lot of failure modes that just simply will not be addressed by the structural analysis alone blue want to add on that or we can continue talking about this yes sir i can say a couple things so i think

um agent-based modeling is a super useful approach when you are getting into systems that that are multi-agent that

like are maybe predictive of any kind of outcome so like if this then that like how many agents does it take to defect

um for a system to fail like you know if if um everybody unloads their nfts all at once then the system collapses all right so it's these kinds of things and and what is the the cognitive uh underpinnings what are the cognitive

underpinnings of the decision making in an agent because everybody's influenced by a variety of factors uh personal and environmental so agents can start off with like more of a of a different disposition

like than others which is how we are in the real world and um you know can have different reactions to environmental cues um and i think that that's all i'll say about that great point agent-based modeling

is really helpful for counterfactual analyses because we can ask well what what would be different if we had this many instead of that many of this kind of entity or if they could do this instead of that

going back to the critical infrastructure and the need to design them reliably and also de-risk against a variety of failure modes web 3 has some failure modes and threat surfaces that are very similar to what is seen in web 2 and just other technological areas and there's also some unique and partially modeled scenarios in web 3 relating to blockchain and distributed technologies specifically and a lot of the complexities come from the nested scales of decision making and modeling that come into play in web 3.

so just speaking coarsely there are decisions and discourse at the level of layer one chains

themselves like blockchains or among blockchains as we're observing in this uh current day around the ethereum changes that are happening known as the merge but even within a layer one chain there are multiple tokens and other kinds of entities on that chain and different communities that might be using

the same or different tokens or their own tokens and teams and projects that might be on chain or off chain so there's a lot of interacting and nested layers of analysis so considering how different effects greetings jakub how different effects of different actors percolate through that kind of a complex system

is a key question and we can talk about a few different yakub i'm going to make you

invited to speak we can talk about a few different modeling paradigms and approaches

and talk about what is state of the art and used wisely widely and wisely today and then how cognitive modeling specifically might be complementary and empowering those methods so just speaking broadly i'm going to mention smart contract auditing and then top-down structural approaches and then lastly bottom-up

agentic approaches which is the cognitive modeling approach so first just speaking to smart contract auditing smart contracts are familiar in financial areas and in kind of on-chain defy applications

although smart contracts also underlie technologies like dow and d-sci and citations identity intellectual property all kinds of aspects of society and culture may be occurring through broadly what are known as smart contracts and the computational details of smart contracts can be audited along the lines of

security audits for other kinds of computational programs for example a hacker noon article describes

that smart contract auditing identifies any errors in the code and ensures that the code is safe to use

when transferring funds and so that kind of smart contract auditing is able to assess whether for

example a given reservoir of funds can be extracted by an unauthorized user uh that is absolutely valuable and we're not suggesting that cognitive modeling replaces that we have two modes of systems modeling beyond simple smart contract auditing that are relevant and that's the top-down structural modeling and the bottom-up modeling perhaps yakup you could describe top-down and bottom-up approaches to modeling here

yeah sure um by the way i'm on my phone right now because uh i uh i'm just walking in the middle of uh the city so if the background noise is too loud just let me know yeah on the so on the top down versus bottom up approach i think the main um the main i guess in classical cat cat modeling the one of the main approaches is to um identify the structure of the of the system that's being studied in this case it could be a decentralized protocol that uh enforces certain behaviors by smart contracts and then this kind of uh top-down structural modeling is diameter sweeps where we try to identify all the different um all the different states that the system can reach and but that doesn't really tell us anything about what state the system will actually reach and how it performs from the perspective of its users so the bottom-up cognitive sweeps but on

okay yakup your audience a little bit

uh more rigorous cognitive analysis from the perspective of the of the participants within that system um so the idea behind active block friends is to kind of balance these two approaches and to take insights from um from both i hope that provides a brief overview yep thank you i'll just kind of summarize that because there's a little bit of cutting in and out but the top down and the structural approach to modeling which is commonly used in tokenomic suites like cad cad that was mentioned by yakub it describes system states like the yield return percentage on some kind of a smart contract and other system parameters and then it specifies the state spaces which those parameters can exist in and these tools also enable parameter sweeping across those system parameters and that's like a macroeconomic analysis that can be said to be taking like a population level approach to modeling the behaviors of these complex systems so that would be equivalent to like modeling a macroeconomic sector with systems of equations and then exploring how those equations influence each other and in contrast there's a bottom-up agentic approach which entails a cognitive model of the agents because the cognitive model is which we're using uh in the active inference sense of the generative model that provides that agent with the ability to engage in perception cognition and action where cognition is describing various functionalities like memory preference and action selection anticipation and so on so we've been thinking about this angle of cognitive modeling in web3 a lot because our project active blockference is an open source package that is explicitly addressing and trying to enable this kind of cognitive modeling in web3

um and we're going to have a bunch of time to discuss aspects of where cognitive modeling could apply in web3

and i'm gonna highlight um three areas but we'll discuss them one by one and also if anyone listening wants

to

join they can absolutely feel welcome um and there's going to be three areas or points of contact to explore so this should be pretty fun and uh blue and yakup after each one of them like please feel free to share how you see it playing out or what you think is useful about it so here's reason one for why we'll argue that web3 needs cognitive modeling it is that we need to understand the consequences of single actions taken by single actors there are also singular events that happen at the system level that we might want to model like rare or really important cascade type events like a flipping and that might be able to be modeled or detected or designed around using top-down structural approaches again thinking about macroeconomics one could imagine they have some dynamical equations describing different currencies and then they could identify like a change point when one currency flipped another that's the flipping we're also interested in the potentially cascading consequences of single actions by single actors so this one specific transaction that this one address sends to this one smart contract is possibly able to induce widespread consequences for the whole system and that level of atomic granularity in terms of which entity did which affordance which action towards which entity and then understanding the consequences of that action at that granularity it simply is inexpressible within the structural or top-down mode of modeling which really can be said to abstract over individual entities and actions so we're not denying that the structural the top-down can provide an immensely coarse-grained useful representation of systems during design and implementation but also we in this first point argue that web 3 needs cognitive modeling because we do want to model and understand the consequences of single actions that single actors take blue or yakup go ahead yakup if you have anything there i will defect and wait until we talk about multi-agent systems i think yeah i think uh i might add that also there's also a lot of um interesting overlap with um the work on computational psychiatry or uh other kind of psychology oriented uh models in the sense that these um by analyzing by analyzing the cognitive states of agents uh things like how uh what what are their levels of curiosity within within within within a system or um is it is um is the distribution of beliefs more skewed towards uh higher levels of uncertainty or um is is 10% of such and such group have this condition, and of them, then 1% go on to do this, and 1% of that goes on to be this way. And so one could develop estimates like per 1,000 people with this characteristic, we can expect these outcomes as a healthcare system or as an educational system. But again, the level of expressivity or granularity to describe measurements coming from a given individual, like self-report, or measurements made of their brain and their body, these kinds of measurements just don't have a place in structural top-down modeling. So it may be absolutely useful to take this macroeconomic structural top-down perspective to have population-level descriptives.

However, the view from the inside, the bottom-up and the agentic perspective, and to incorporate the kinds of data and information which we have in the blockchain case, like individual addresses making transactions, we need to have agent-level modeling to be able to have that kind of a personalized clinical relationship, a personalized education relationship,

or making systems that account for what individual actors expect, prefer, and can do, rather than just designing systems only at the level of system state space parameters, and then expecting that somehow whatever it is that agents expect or prefer or can do will simply work within that framework.

Okay, so that was the first point about why Web3 needs cognitive modeling, because again, it's important to model and understand the consequences of single actions that single actors take,

which might be extraordinarily rare or improbable,

and so we won't be able to have useful top-down modeling of those kinds of actions.

Here's a second point.

We believe that Web3 needs cognitive modeling,

because we want to consider the function of Web3 systems that are not simply quantitative or financial.

For example, science, research, education, governance,

all of these areas are not strictly about number crunching,

and so in these settings, knowledge and meaning, which are based around context,

and we could even say that they're non-fungible,

knowledge and meaning-making of epistemic entities

will not be engaged with by top-down structural modeling or smart contract auditing,

because quite literally, it is about the situated entity and their epistemic experience,

like the kinds of observations that they're making and how that's updating their generative model

and then what that is helping them to do.

So the way that that would get shoehorned into a structural model

would be assume that some percentage of individuals are going to listen to this podcast,

and then that makes some of them more likely to engage in this action.

So that is, again, that view from the top,

just like we explored in the computational psychiatry case,

that view from the top, or a probabilistic way to talk about the actions of groups,

and this is the complementary view, which is the view from the bottom,

and this second point is just to say that,

especially if we're going to step beyond quantitative and financial analyses,

that these kinds of knowledge and meaning-making behavior of entities

are just doubly inaccessible unless we have cognitive modeling.

So to design appropriate systems for science, education, governance,

we will need to have models of what individuals observe, believe, prefer, and do,

rather than hoping that we can simply specify the state space that the system can exist in and then let individuals run within that framework.

Blue?

So I'll follow up on that.

I think that, like, yes, for the DSAI,

but also systems like regenerative finance

will require novel methods of accounting,

and so this kind of cognitive modeling will enable,

I think what Jacob was saying earlier that maybe Daniel,

you haven't touched on yet,

but this parameter sweeping,

So when a person values something, whether it's carbon credits or epistemic knowledge,

so when the value system differs from dollars and cents, these kinds of ultimate accounting systems are enabled or facilitated by this kind of cognitive modeling.

Will these value systems and structures work for these people?

And, you know, multi-agent systems can have variable value systems.

So I think that these parameters will greatly help us to determine what kind of alternative accounting structures would be.

Yes.

And there's many ways, and it is by no means trivial, to incorporate these really rich and expressive things that we want to say about such systems into the model.

For example, even just in the example that Blue brought up with regenerative finance, to describe how different individuals are making different decisions, that might be a function of differences in their capacities.

So their affordances, their capacities for action.

It might also reflect different attention or different beliefs about the consequences of different actions.

And so there are vast combinations of cognitive models to explore.

And for that reason, being able to do parameter sweeps across them, which is what CAD CAD, the package enables, is really valuable.

And that's why ActiveBlockference is implementing active inference models in CAD CAD, because it provides a useful and professional way to do some of these functions that are just not part of cognitive models in a narrow sense, like being able to do parameter sweeps, being able to specify the execution order.

But that's a bit more on the technical side of ActiveBlockference, which definitely we encourage people to learn more and get involved with and help with.

I'll just go to this third.

Yes, Blue.

Okay.

Okay.

Yeah.

If I could just quickly follow up on that.

On the notion of parameter sweeps, I think they also serve two kinds of functions.

On the one hand, it's for predictive purposes.

So designing models of different organizational systems and running multiple simulations to evaluate the different consequences of that system.

On the other hand, it can also serve an explanatory purpose whereby we want to evaluate the state of an already existing system, given data on the blockchain.

So what active, what the formalism of ActiveInference allows us to do is to take data from the blockchain on the different actions that different agents take or actors within the system take, and then do a parameter sweep over their beliefs to identify which set of beliefs make their actions based optimal.

And once we identify that set of beliefs, we can do further analysis on what that means from a cognitive sense in what would that mean in different scenarios and do this kind of more retrospective analysis of the system.

And one more thing on the voting mechanisms, just to give an example.

I think there's an increasing or it is increasingly mentioned that quadratic voting is a more optimal paradigm for voting and governance in general.

But why is it quadratic?

Why isn't there a third exponent or fourth exponent?

And these kinds of questions, I think, can be answered through cognitive modeling, where we can evaluate the tradeoff between higher mathematical complexity, where the operation itself at more cognitive constraint and the actual results when the agents act within that voting system.

So just wanted to give this example of how it can be used in a purely non-monetary governance type setting.

Nice points.

You laid out a lot of the kind of modeling pipeline, which is that the blockchains themselves actually already contain the exact kind of agent level empirical data that we want.

And it's even structured in the way that we want to take it in, which is like which entity, which address did what?

And then what was the consequence of the action?

So indeed, that information is already on chain and summarized in a way that's amenable to fitting cognitive parameters.

So the question of how to determine which cognitive models are relevant is it's indeed a challenge.

But at the same time, the data that is input is of the right type to fit various cognitive models that could be useful.

For example, some hidden state that describes how much attention somebody is paying to a given governance system overall.

And then also being able to subspecify at a given time or changing through time their preferences on a variety of topics.

And that's exactly what allows the counterfactual analysis or exploring like alternate futures, because we could ask, well, what if people were paying more attention?

Is that an important area to go or should it be explored to modify not the attention being paid to this issue, but rather how much they know about it?

So nice point there. So for financial and for non-financial systems where entity level knowledge and meaning making is relevant, which it arguably always is.

That is an important opening for cognitive modeling and this view from the inside to complement the top down structural modeling.

Okay. Okay.

Okay.

Okay.

I'm going to just mention the third of the points and then in the rest of the hour, we can hear some different questions, different thoughts.

So anyone who wants to speak, thanks for requesting.

And the third point is that we argue that cognitive modeling can complement traditional computational security analyses.

So that's like static and dynamic analysis of smart contracts.

And those kinds of analyses can be complemented by exploring in a test net or in a sandbox setting what happens when that smart contract is deployed in realistic settings, which is to say interacting with other contracts and interacting with individuals who might differ in their capacities, preferences, expectations, and so on.

So just to kind of give an example that seems relevant here.

Smart contract analysis could determine if there was a contract which was supposed to hold funds securely and only be able to take in one or two kinds of tokens like a vending machine.

You can put dollars in and then soda comes out or you put soda in and dollars comes out.

So potentially like a liquidity pool based swap.

Now, standalone analysis of that smart contract could absolutely tell you whether it was possible for somebody who shouldn't be able to access those funds was able to access those funds.

So, there are also failure modes and risks associated with that smart contract in operation that can't be said to be within the smart contract rather they're in the relationship of that smart contract with others.

For example, other contracts or exchanges that are handling that token might be engaged in arbitrage relationships.

Once we think about social media and information sharing that happens off chain, there might even be narrative or news based events which make it so that that smart contracts ability to hold the funds is great and enabling.

However, still in the realized application of the contract is functionally getting rugged as well.

And so these are all areas that we want to explore more with the active block for its package as we kind of build in these modules to consider it and do case study analysis.

But that is just to close this section of the discussion as we now open up to more broader discussion.

And just to restate that three of the key areas we think cognitive modeling can play a role in Web3 are first understanding the consequences of single actions by single actors.

Second, by expanding the scope of Web3 systems that we consider and design for to be systems that aren't simply quantitative and financial.

So considering research, education, governance, and so on.

And then lastly, complementing computational security analyses with emulations and simulation scenarios and counterfactuals of how different aspects of cyber physical systems might play out in specific areas.

In specific testable settings.

So thanks for making it along this far.

And now we can just talk about whatever people would like to go towards.

Right.

Thank you.

So one of the things that's on my mind is that this is maybe abstracting away an important layer that you can use.

And I think that's a little bit of a layer that we're not really speaking about whether we're doing bottom up modeling or top down.

And that is, you know, that there are me so or middle level structures that are relevant.

And that's a little bit of a layer that we're doing in terms of, you know, in terms of communities, cultures, organizations, and they have an influence on the mental model that a person has.

So I'm very explicitly by just talking about a wallet.

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A wallet might belong to an individual or it might belong to an entity, but their behaviors will tend to be different.

might not even know perhaps whether it is an individual or some other sort of entity that's

behind a wallet but i think it gets more tricky to think about well you know what is the environment

in which that entity that has the wallet exists in like what culture what regulatory

regime like what communities are they they part of and i don't necessarily know how that should be

done but it seems like that is an important part of the context that influences the model that any agent

has in choosing whatever transactions they make with their wallet and so maybe we have to think

about how to address that or if you have thoughts about how that should work they haven't

thank you ray for this comment about the meso scale and i think there's just a few points to add on that

structural specifications of systems they identify really important system level parameters

and then it can often be challenging to add in other parameters because the models are composable

only with macro aspects so it becomes hard to compose models that are taking a purely top down as well as

a purely bottom-up angle where cognitive modeling might help us explore that middle is that it makes

a specific distinction between observed and unobserved aspects of systems so hidden states are unobserved

states the observed behavior in a blockchain setting are like the transactions that happen on chain and then you're right that there's so much context that is unobserved in that one data artifact that would be relevant to know about and so we can think about two cases where this context is either used or not the first case is where we actually have no other context in that situation we can still do intentional stance modeling towards unknown types of actors like we don't know what is behind this address but we know that they engage with this kind of a pattern and it's not enough just to take a top down perspective and say well this many people interacted with this contract or the average was two times per day

because that two times per day might be the average of a small fraction that interact 100 times per day and some that interact infrequently so cognitive modeling first would help us take an intentional and a strategic stance in a strategic stance in the absence of context and then context as we add it in can become useful so we might know that multiple addresses are under the control of a given team or individual or we might have access to connecting um the social media profile of somebody who puts it in their ens um profile or page that could be composable at the agent level and uh i don't think that's an answer that's an answer at all so open to whatever else people add um because the meso is where the complexity is and we would just expect and prefer that the composability of specifying different kinds of entities not just on chain entities but also teams organizations and so on that that will enable these kinds of models to do exploration and parameter sweeps in that exact space you described thank you i would maybe also add to that that as the toolbox itself uh gets expanded and different um um different computational models um are added i think it's the the case where we want to distinguish between an actor that's actually a single single human versus a team of people controlling and multi multi sick should technically be reflected in the underlying data to some uh to some extent say if uh if for instance you want to analyze um you want to use cognitive modeling to analyze a certain dao and you have a list of all the different addresses um as you perform this kind of multi-agent model or even try to uh fit the the belief states of each of the wallets given given the prior data it should become evident that certain that certain wallets perhaps are operating at slightly different time scales or um or are or are maintain are uh are updating their beliefs at uh again a different time scales or in a slightly different way than the other agents and there and then we might also do some cross correlation between the belief states of the individual actors about which we perhaps know that they are individual actors and the agents that we are not sure whether they represent a single uh entity or a group of people uh so i think that a lot of it might already implicitly be available uh within within the current toolbox but as we add more algorithms that do more efficient uh computations and different schemes of performing uh belief updates and belief search i think that's a very interesting area to explore as well thanks jacob brock you want to add anything

um yeah i think jacob's point here about you know having some verified data sources and having these kinds of

generalities about how one kind of data source looks like for one kind of agent versus another kind you know um more of an organization or a syndicate or some some other kind of non-singular individual

um is uh correct um and i think that this idea of you know the meso scale being missed generally speaking and modeling is also correct um but i and i i think that cognitive modeling in general affords partially i guess a solution to really this meso both of these problems are really related to like the oracle problem of just where does data come from and who do you trust and all this sort of stuff um because even if you get this culture data it's like you know what's what's in the water what's in the food what's this business doing with you know what are the externalities of this process or whatever you know there's a lot of still unknown data and the only way that we currently have to kind of um model that effectively is with essentially a cognitive sort of modeling that um like you mentioned daniel has this distinction between observed and unobserved or hidden states and um you know known

states to the system and so um it's never i guess to frame it it's it's like security is this cat and mouse game really we're in this now in this cognitive security cat and mouse game and we're just going to go further into that but you know is a large corporation or whatever some some syndicate whatever trying to maybe obscure their you know um behavior on chain like uh so that they're harder to predict for some reason um probably things like that will they already occur in the political context today um i'm sure that it will continue and decentralize in that fashion and so it will just be

be a baseline this will just be table stakes to do cognitive modeling to have any kind of grip on something like prediction or um discernibility of of these kinds of systems nice very interesting so in the last 10 minutes we can

have any speakers join or people can ask questions this is happening during the ongoing bitcoin funding round gr15 and we have a grant in for this project which is supportable as well as many other awesome public goods and projects projects that people can check out and um on the grant page you'll see some

recent discussions we've had with cad cad community and with the smart contract research forum where we talked about a few different ongoing steps the current status of the package is that it's it's available it's an open source package and it is framed as notebooks primarily made by yakub that are like the perception cognition and action of an entity in an abstract grid space which sounds and basically is general and abstract so some of our next steps are to bring that machinery and that approach to take in the kinds of empirical data that are relevant for blockchain systems so that's one key area as well as well as um improving the functionality of the package through various means like improved ability to visualize outcomes of models to specify models and sweep across them to have documentation and other integrations that will just make it a better package and more useful um

um i guess in the last 10 minutes there's a few other ways to go but i'll pause if anyone has any thoughts or questions

the point i wanted to add in and then again anyone can feel free to add is that using active inference as a scale free or scale friendly framework as we sometimes say an advantage of it is that we can talk about perception cognition and action for different

entities this is not creating a little brain for individuals only people this is about being able to look at how decisions are enacted in different kinds of organizations and those organizations could be cellular biological organizations like humans or it could be organizations that you suspect something complex is happening within but you're only seeing the tip of the iceberg on chain or it could be organizations that are entirely on chain and so that's one of the reasons why it's important to have a really flexible modeling framework like active inference for cognitive systems because it's not bound to for example only human emotions and sensory processing it enables us to describe a wide variety of systems in a cognitive fashion which is what we've explored in our eos work active entity ontology for science so that is where we see active inference as a leading cognitive modeling framework and natural fit for this cyber physical space and then the other pillar of the active blockference project other than active inference is cad cad which was mentioned earlier and cad cad has been used in a wide range of token modeling and engineering settings you can see actually their ethereum validator models which have been publicly available for several years i don't know the exact date but the um work on cad cad modeling of the f proof of stake the f proof of stake transition has been in the works for a really long time and that kind of gives a a taste of from the outside speaking personally of what it looks like to use formal system models over long time scales to strategize and de-risk really complex decisions that groups and individuals make and that is still at the structural level so it's one thing to be able to scan across different validator reward systems or percentages and ask what would happen if a certain parameter is set to three or two or one again it's quite a different thing to ask how entities with different attentions and preferences will make certain decisions and so it'd be like the equivalent of a macroeconomic change being induced like we raised the interest rate by one percent our macroeconomic curve intersection models show that that should increase consumer spending by this much but that consumer spending even if it is an accurate prediction from the structural modeling it is enacted by individuals making decisions in response to those common system parameters so that highlights that the agentic perspective is complementary to the systems and the structural description but we really think that it's going to bring a level of depth and also new challenges because the state space of all cognitive parameters and how they interact is truly vast so it will not be necessarily the the shortest or simplest road but we think it's going to be one of the most meaningful because it's going to bring new function to different web3 ecosystems and subsystems that otherwise would have totally incommensurate models the defy models are not going to apply to dower decision making and those are not going to apply to science and how that works and having some kind of an interoperable layer for what entities are doing what is going to be enabling really rich modeling of web3 ecosystems now can web3 survive without cognitive modeling i don't know we could vote but we we provocatively raised the question i think um jacob and brock and others in some meetings with with this

this framing because we do want to suggest or at least raise this notion that no amount of top level systems engineering unless it's complemented by a bottom-up perspective on what are the capacities attentions preferences and so on of entities in this world the embodied natural ones as well as like computational artifacts you know a runaway decision-making ai with a trading balance all these kinds of systems that we have to model including systems that we don't even know what type they are necessarily we need interoperable and expressive ways to describe those systems so that's why we think that web3 with cognitive modeling can survive and without we just don't know that's why we don't know what type of data is available so um it's very clear always what data is available like what transactions are on chain or what prices are paid uh in market for securities or commodity what have you but there is actually a lot that occurs in society which is not necessarily a market type activity with with hard data associated with it and how does a cognitive model account for the fact that that many things are missed and that we we simply overlook many aspects of things that for instance might be called the the gift economy where people just informally do things for each other and it's not really recorded anywhere i mean it is truly part of the representation of our individual cognitive models for how we exist in the world but where is this going to the world that we're going to make it into any model that we try to do it's a great question and it's a thread i hope we keep alive even beyond this space ending in a few minutes so no answer will do it justice but

i'll give some thoughts one is the difference between observables in our model empirical data that we're reading in in and unobservables which are considered factors but not necessarily ones where we have data points either because we just haven't added those data points in or maybe they don't even exist in principle so various kinds of features can be observed and various can't be so it's important to have a framework that deals with both and then the second point is that it may be possible for some kind of like out in the open models to use some kinds of totally out in the open data but then let's just say that within the context of a given community of care people consented to having their information digested or summarized and used to augment a community specific model so the provenance and the use of that data that would be potentially speaking to these more authentic inorganic social interactions those kinds of data could be grafted or fused with more open source templates dealing with open data so there'd be a lot of opportunity for model templates and some pre-computed public goods type data sets to then be enriched on the edges by different communities that we're going to be bringing in specific data types and the the path has been in a way blazed forward by cad cad where the package is open source and many of their models are open source yet they're also able to engage with clients in a consulting capacity using models that are not fully open source probably or data sets that aren't fully available so it's one reason why we are uh strongly open source with the package while also recognizing that a lot of the last mile use cases might bring in data that isn't strictly open source in the same way that this code should be

okay well thanks for listening everyone please uh head over to i guess our twitter profile to learn more and we'll talk a little bit more about our ongoing gitcoin grant